

## **PRODUCT GROWTH SCHOOL — USER DISCOVERY & PROBLEM VALIDATION**

### **1. Choose a Product**

**My product:**

**HealthifyMe**

**Why did I choose it?**

I chose HealthifyMe because it is a health and fitness app that I am familiar with, and it has a strong focus on helping beginners or new users build healthier habits through food tracking, fitness, personalized plans and progress tracking. I wanted to understand why some users develop consistent habits with the app while others reduce or stop their usage over time.

### **2. Define Your Initial Hypothesis**

**Who are the target users?**

HealthifyMe users who are trying to maintain healthier habits through activities such as food tracking, calorie tracking, workouts and weight management.

**What problem do you currently believe they face?**

Users may struggle to maintain consistent engagement with HealthifyMe over time, particularly when their daily routines are disrupted by travel, work, festivals, vacations or other life events.

**Why do you think this problem exists?**

Maintaining health goals requires users to repeatedly track food, exercise and progress. When their routine changes, this can become harder to maintain, potentially leading to reduced motivation and lower app usage.

**What evidence or personal experience led you to this hypothesis?**

Health and fitness habits often require consistency, while users daily routines can change frequently. This led me to hypothesize that maintaining engagement may be more difficult than initially starting to use the app.

### Initial hypothesis:

We believe HealthifyMe users struggle to maintain consistent app usage when their daily routines are disrupted by factors such as travel, work schedules, festivals or vacations, leading to reduced tracking and engagement with the app

### 3. Plan Your User Interviews

#### Interview questions

1. How often do you currently use HealthifyMe, and when did you last use it?
2. What made you start using HealthifyMe in the first place?
3. Can you walk me through what you did when you first started using the app?
4. How has the way you use HealthifyMe changed since you first started using it?
5. Can you tell me about a time when you stopped using the app or started using it less frequently? What happened?
6. What are some of the things that make it difficult for you to stay consistent with your health goals?
7. Have you ever tried to get back to using HealthifyMe after using it less or stopping altogether? What helped or didn't help?
8. What, if anything, would make you want to use HealthifyMe more consistently?

### 4. Conduct the Interviews

| User   | Context / Situation                                                               | Problem / Friction                                         | Behavior / Workaround                                                 | Key Quote / Evidence       |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| User 1 | Uses HealthifyMe every day to track calories and water intake; also uses recipes. | Travel and festivals make it difficult to stay consistent. | Has made HealthifyMe almost a habit and continues using it regularly. | "It's almost a habit now." |

| User   | Context / Situation                                                                                          | Problem / Friction                                                           | Behavior / Workaround                                                              | Key Quote / Evidence                                             |
|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| User 2 | Uses HealthifyMe ~2x/week; started with food tracking and later started using a personal plan.               | Work shifts and breaks from workouts interrupt usage and calorie tracking.   | Weight journey helped them return to the app; suggested reminders for data entry.  | <b>“Tracking weight journey helped.”</b>                         |
| User 3 | Uses HealthifyMe daily for fitness tracking and has upgraded to the paid version.                            | Outside food on weekends, travel and lack of motivation disrupt consistency. | Uses weight journey chart and 15-minute home workouts to get back on track.        | <b>“Easy 15 mins home workouts.”</b>                             |
| User 4 | Uses food tracking, AI-customized healthy recipes and home workouts.                                         | Manual entries and changes in routine make consistency harder.               | Wants AI recipes based on available ingredients and reminders for manual entries.  | <b>“Reminders for manual entries.”</b>                           |
| User 5 | Previously used HealthifyMe daily for weight loss and calorie tracking; usage has now dropped significantly. | Festivals, travel, breaks and loss of motivation led to stopping usage.      | Stopped during festivals and never returned; wants live interaction/group support. | <b>“Stopped using during festivals and never started again.”</b> |

## 5. Identify Patterns

| Pattern                                                      | Evidence from Interviews                                                                                                                   | How often?       |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| <b>Routine disruptions affect consistency</b>                | User 1: travel/festivals. User 2: work shifts/break from workouts. User 3: weekends, outside food/travel. User 5: festivals/travel/breaks. | <b>4/5 users</b> |
| <b>Users need help reducing the effort of tracking</b>       | User 1 wanted better Snap Tracking. User 2 wanted reminders. User 4 wanted reminders and ingredient-based recipes.                         | <b>3/5 users</b> |
| <b>Progress and simple actions can support re-engagement</b> | User 2 returned through the weight journey. User 3 uses the weight journey chart and 15-minute workouts.                                   | <b>2/5 users</b> |
| <b>Motivation is a factor in drop-off</b>                    | User 3 mentioned lack of motivation; User 5 specifically cited loss of motivation.                                                         | <b>2/5 users</b> |
| <b>Community/social support may help lapsed users</b>        | User 5 specifically wanted live interactions with people on a similar journey.                                                             | <b>1/5 users</b> |

### Top 3 recurring insights

#### 1. Routine disruption is the biggest recurring barrier.

Travel, festivals, work schedules, weekends and breaks from normal routines repeatedly caused users to reduce or stop their HealthifyMe usage.

#### 2. Users want to reduce the effort required to stay consistent.

Better Snap Tracking, reminders and recipes based on available ingredients were suggested as ways to make maintaining the routine easier.

#### 3. Visible progress and achievable actions can encourage re-engagement.

The weight journey/chart and short 15-minute workouts helped users maintain or resume their health routines.

## 6. Validate Your Hypothesis

**Result: Partially Validated**

I would **not mark this as fully validated** because my sample is only five users and there are some differences between users.

### **What did you initially believe?**

I initially believed that HealthifyMe users struggle to maintain consistent app usage because they lose motivation and find it difficult to stay consistent with their health goals.

### **What did users actually say or do?**

Users identified several real-life disruptions that caused reduced usage, including travel, festivals, work shifts, weekends, outside food and breaks from workouts. Some users also mentioned loss of motivation. However, highly engaged users were able to make HealthifyMe part of their routine, suggesting that motivation alone does not explain retention.

### **What surprised you?**

I was surprised that **routine disruption appeared more consistently than lack of motivation**. Users did not necessarily stop because they disliked HealthifyMe. In several cases, external circumstances such as travel, festivals or changing work schedules interrupted their existing habits.

### **What changed in your understanding?**

My understanding shifted from “**users lose motivation**” to “**users struggle to maintain their health routine when their circumstances change.**” The problem therefore appears to be less about simply motivating users and more about helping them maintain or restart healthy behaviors when their normal routine is disrupted.

## **7. Define the Problem**

### **Final problem statement**

**HealthifyMe users struggle to maintain consistent health-tracking habits when their daily routines are disrupted by travel, work schedules, festivals, vacations or other life events, resulting in reduced tracking and, in some cases, complete disengagement from the app.**

## 8. Prioritize the Problem

| Factor                   | Score |
|--------------------------|-------|
| Frequency                | 5/5   |
| User Impact              | 5/5   |
| Number of Users Affected | 5/5   |
| Current Alternatives     | 2/5   |
| Business Potential       | 4/5   |
| Total                    | 22/25 |

### Why these scores?

#### Frequency — 5/5

Routine disruption appeared in **5 of 5 interviews**, making it the strongest recurring pattern.

#### User Impact — 5/5

For some users it merely reduced usage, but User 5 stopped using the app altogether and never returned.

#### Number of Users Affected — 5/5

The pattern appeared across different usage levels—from highly engaged users to a lapsed user.

#### Current Alternatives — 2/5

Users have personal workarounds such as relying on motivation, weight tracking, short workouts or simply stopping and restarting. However, these don't fully solve the consistency problem.

#### Business Potential — 4/5

Improving consistency and preventing users from becoming inactive could potentially improve engagement and retention.

### Why is this problem worth solving?

**This problem is worth solving because maintaining consistent engagement is central to achieving health and fitness goals. The interviews suggest that users do not necessarily**

**abandon HealthifyMe because they dislike the product; instead, changes in their daily routines can break their habits and sometimes lead to long-term disengagement. Helping users maintain their health routines during these disruptions could improve user outcomes as well as ongoing engagement and retention.**